

Fangzhou Sha

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Education

Southern Methodist University	Expected 2027
Ph.D. in Economics	
Advisor: Nathan S. Balke; Committee: Rocío Madera Holgado, Ömer Özak, Michael Sposi	
Southern Methodist University	2023
M.A. in Economics	
University of Wisconsin–Madison	2021
M.S. in Economics	
Shanghai University of Finance and Economics	2019
B.B.A. in Accounting	

Research

Job Market Paper

Unfunded Fiscal Policy with Heterogeneity in Household Portfolios

This paper studies the circumstances under which government deficits become inflationary. Using a rich heterogeneous-household model, it shows that differences in how much households spend out of additional income have only limited power to explain why fiscal expansions become inflationary, while expectations about whether government debt will be backed by future surpluses explain a much larger share of the response.

Working Papers

- *Fiscal Policy, Aggregate Demand, and Equilibrium Determinacy*
- *Identifying the Effects of Funded vs. Unfunded Fiscal Shocks* with Nathan S. Balke and Carlos Zarazaga

Work in Progress

- *Financial Frictions, Firm Exit, and Aggregate Dynamics* with Nathan S. Balke and Enrique Martínez-García
- *High Dimensional Predictive Regression with Cointegration* with Zhan Gao

Selected Awards and Fellowships

- Melody Rice Memorial Award, SMU 2026
- Outstanding Graduate Student Award, Southern Economic Association 2025
- Outstanding Graduate Student Instruction Award, SMU 2025
- Provost's Summer Research Grant, SMU 2025
- Best Third-Year Paper Award, Department of Economics, SMU 2024
- Provost's Doctoral Candidacy Fellowship, SMU 2023–2026
- Nomination, Best Master's Thesis, University of Wisconsin–Madison 2021
- Xu Zhendan Scholarship, Shanghai University of Finance and Economics 2018

Selected Presentations

Unfunded Fiscal Policy with Heterogeneity in Household Portfolios

SEA Graduate Student Sessions (2025); NTxEC (2025); SMU Brown Bag (2025)

Teaching Experience

Southern Methodist University

Instructor: Intermediate Macroeconomics

Invited Speaker: Teaching Strategies and Tools workshop, Moody School Leadership Academy

Teaching Assistant: Intermediate Macroeconomics; Applied Econometric Analysis; Principles of Macroeconomics (Honors); Micro Theory II; Predictive Analytics; Forecasting